# Holden Holden 48-215 (FX) (Australia) Specification & Service Reference - Page 1/1

## AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Holden | Model: Holden 48-215 (FX) | Australian Market Years: 1948-1953
Vehicle Type: Sedan / Coupe Utility / Business Sedan | Segment: Mid-size | Locally Built: Yes
Assembly Plants (AU): Fishermans Bend, Victoria, Woodville, South Australia, Pagewood, New South Wales, T

### 1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

The Holden 48-215 (retrospectively referred to as the 'FX') was Australia's first mass-produced domestic motor vehicle, famously unveiled on 29 November 1948 by Prime Minister Ben Chifley with the words: 'She's a beauty!'. Developed under GM Project 2000, it combined American interior room and robust unibody construction with European operating economy, tailored specifically for Australia's harsh corrugated roads. In January 1951, the 50-2106 Coupe Utility was launched, defining the iconic Australian 'ute', followed in July 1953 by the 48-215-257 Business Sedan for taxi operators. Over 120,402 examples were produced.

The 48-215 introduced unitary (monocoque) construction to Australian volume manufacturing, eliminating heavy separate chassis rails while providing extraordinary torsional rigidity. Powered by the legendary 132.5ci (2.16L) overhead valve 'Grey Motor' inline-six, it easily outperformed British four-cylinder rivals in hill-climbing, highway cruising, and reliability. Customer demand was so overwhelming that waiting lists stretched out past two years, establishing Holden's 70-year reign over Australian automotive culture.

### SERIES / GENERATION: 48-215 (Holden 48-215 / 50-2106) [1948-1953]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 2-door coupe utility, 4-door business sedan | ANCAP: None
First Australian-manufactured mass-market automobile. Features integral chassis-body construction, 2.16L Grey motor, 3-speed manual column shift, and independent front coil spring suspension.

**Engines Offered in Australia:**

- Grey-132: 2.16L (2160cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 45.0 kW / 136.0 Nm

**Australian Badges / Trims:**

- Standard Sedan: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column, AUD $1466-$1580, Fuel=9.4L/100km
- Coupe Utility (50-2106): Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column, AUD $1380-$1490, Fuel=9.6L/100k
- Business Sedan (48-215-257): Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column, AUD $1550-$1620, Fuel=9.5L/

**Factory Configurations:**

* Standard Sedan | Sedan | Grey-132 | 3-speed manual column | RWD | 45.0kW/136.0Nm
* Coupe Utility (50-2106) | Coupe Utility | Grey-132 | 3-speed manual column | RWD | 45.0kW/136.0Nm
* Business Sedan (48-215-257) | Sedan | Grey-132 | 3-speed manual column | RWD | 45.0kW/136.0Nm